The mention Package

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Abstract

The mention package adds targeted collaborative comments on top of phfcc. Comments remain visible inline in the source document, while only the addressed collaborator sees margin highlights and a header summary of unresolved comments for the active viewer.

Contents

1 Introduction

Collaborative drafts often need comments that are visible in context but routed to a specific co-author. The mention package provides one command per author, a recipient list for each comment, optional important-comment styling, and a resolved flag that keeps old comments visible without counting them as open work.

The package is intentionally small. It depends on phfcc for the base commenting environment and on common LaTeX packages for colors, margin notes, and command parsing. Automatic viewer detection is best-effort; projects that need the most predictable behavior should use a local `phfcc-local.cfg` file.

2 Installation

Place `mention.sty` where TeX can find it. For a single project, putting the file next to the main `.tex` document is enough:

```
project/
  paper.tex
  mention.sty
  phfcc-local.cfg.example
```

Then load the package with:

```
\usepackage{mention}
```

The package requires phfcc, xparse, xcolor, and marginnote. The optional automatic viewer detection path can use catchfile and texosquery when they are available.

3 Defining Authors

3.1 The author command factory

Define one author command per collaborator:

```
\phfMakeTargetedCommentCommand[
  initials={AL},
  color=blue,
  handle=alice,
  userid=alice-laptop
]{Alice}
```

This defines a command named `\Alice`. Its comments are printed inline using the configured color. If a comment targets the active viewer, a margin note is also printed using the author's initials.

`Option`	Meaning
`initials`	Short text printed in margin notes.
`color`	Any color expression accepted by xcolor.
`handle`	Stable collaborator handle used in recipient lists.
`userid`	Optional system user id mapped to the handle.

If `initials` is omitted, the command name is used. If `handle` is omitted, the lower-cased command name is used. If `color` is omitted, the package chooses the next color from its built-in cycle.

4 Writing Comments

Comments use the optional argument for recipient handles:

```
\Alice[bob]{Please check this lemma.}
\Alice[bob, claire]{Please verify this proof.}
\Alice![bob]{Please add the missing citation.}
\Alice[bob, resolved]{This has already been handled.}
```

The form with `!` marks a comment as important. Important comments use a stronger filled margin label for the active viewer.

The special recipient-list item `resolved` makes a comment dormant. It still appears inline, but it is not routed to anyone, does not get a margin note, and does not contribute to unresolved counts.

5 Viewer Selection

5.1 Direct handle selection

Set the active viewer directly by handle:

```
\phfSetViewer{bob}
```

5.2 User-id selection

Set the active viewer by user id. If the user id was registered through an author's `userid` option, it maps to that author's handle:

```
\phfSetViewerUser{bob-laptop}
```

5.3 Explicit user-id mappings

Register or override an explicit user-id mapping:

```
\phfRegisterViewerUser{bob-laptop}{bob}
```

Viewer selection is resolved in this order:

1. an explicit `\phfSetViewer{...}` call;
2. an explicit `\phfSetViewerUser{...}` call;
3. a local `phfcc-local.cfg` file, if present;
4. best-effort automatic detection.

5.4 Local Configuration

For shared Git repositories, the recommended workflow is to keep `phfcc-local.cfg` ignored and let each collaborator create their own copy from `phfcc-local.cfg.example`.

```
cp phfcc-local.cfg.example phfcc-local.cfg
```

A local config can select a handle:

```
\phfSetViewer{bob}
```

or a user id:

```
\phfSetViewerUser{bob-laptop}
```

The package loads `phfcc-local.cfg` automatically when the document starts.

5.5 Automatic Detection

When no explicit viewer is set, `mention` tries to infer the compiling user. With shell access, it first asks `kpsewhich` for common user variables: `USER`, `USERNAME`, and `LOGNAME`. If that does not work and `texosquery` is available, it tries to derive a user id from the home-directory path.

This detection path is best-effort. It may be unavailable on systems that disable shell escape or do not ship the optional helper packages. Manual viewer selection through `phfcc-local.cfg` does not require shell escape.

6 Header Summary

6.1 The standard header

Enable a centered page-header summary:

```
\phfUseTargetedCommentHeader
```

The summary reports unresolved comments for the active viewer, for example:

```
There are 2 unresolved comments for you.
```

The count is written through the `.aux` file. Compile twice after changing comments or viewer selection.

7 Complete Example

```
\documentclass{article}
\usepackage[margin=1in]{geometry}
\setlength{\marginparwidth}{3cm}
\usepackage{xcolor}
\usepackage{mention}

\phfMakeTargetedCommentCommand[
  initials={AL},
```

```
  color=blue,
  handle=alice,
  userid=alice-laptop
]{Alice}

\phfMakeTargetedCommentCommand[
  initials={BO},
  color=orange,
  handle=bob,
  userid=bob-laptop
]{Bob}

\phfUseTargetedCommentHeader

\begin{document}

We should revise this proof
\Alice[bob]{Please check the induction step.}
before submission.

\Alice![bob]{Please add the missing citation.}
\Alice[bob, resolved]{This earlier point is done.}

\end{document}
```

8 Public Interface

Command	Purpose
\phfMakeTargetedCommentCommand	define an author command
\phfSetViewer	select the active viewer by handle
\phfSetViewerUser	select the active viewer by user id
\phfRegisterViewerUser	map a user id to a handle
\phfUseTargetedCommentHeader	install the standard header
\phfTargetedCommentSummary	typeset only the summary text

The author-command factory has the form:

```
\phfMakeTargetedCommentCommand[options]{CommandName}
```

The viewer commands have the forms:

```
\phfSetViewer{handle}
\phfSetViewerUser{userid}
\phfRegisterViewerUser{userid}{handle}
```

9 Limitations

The response-marker commands

```
\phfMarkCommentResponded
\phfccDeclareResponded
```

are retained only as compatibility stubs and emit a warning. Use the `resolved` flag in a comment recipient list instead.

The package does not hide inline comments from non-recipients. Targeting only controls margin notes and unresolved counts.

10 License

This work consists of the files `README.md`, `mention.tex`, `mention.sty`, `phfcc-local.cfg.example`, and `targeted-comments-demo.tex`, and the derived file `mention.pdf`.